

CHILD SUPPORT GUIDELINES WORKSHEET

Massachusetts Trial Court



Case Name _____
Docket Number _____

Date Prepared _____
Name of Preparer _____

*All dollar amounts are weekly. Round all numbers to the nearest whole dollar or percentage.
You might also need to submit with this worksheet a Findings and Determinations for Child Support and Post-Secondary Education form.*

WORKSHEET SUMMARY

If this form is completed electronically, this summary will autofill based on the information provided below.

PRESUMPTIVE WEEKLY ORDER

 7d

PAYOR AND RECIPIENT

Parent A is the 6f

Parent B is the 6f

ADDITIONAL AVAILABLE INCOME

☐ 3b

Parent A and Parent B have more than \$8,654 per week (\$450,000 per year) of combined available income.

SUBSTANTIAL HARDSHIP DEVIATION

☐ 7e

The presumptive weekly order is 40% or more of the payor's income; a rebuttable presumption of substantial hardship justifying a deviation exists.

1. AGE, NUMBER, AND PARENTING OF CHILDREN

a. Number of children who may be eligible to be covered by this order (Maximum of 5 children)

b. Check the box that applies to the children listed in 1a (check Box 1, 2, or 3 only)

The parents share financial responsibility and parenting time approximately equally (shared).

Box 1 ☐

The children primarily reside with one parent for approximately 2/3 of the time.

Box 2 ☐

There is more than one child covered by the order and each parent provides a primary residence for at least one child (split).

Box 3 ☐

c. Enter each parent's name

If you checked Box 2 above, enter the name of the parent with whom the children primarily reside in the column for Parent A, and the other parent's name as Parent B; otherwise, enter either parent's name in either column.

Parent A

Parent B

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Enter the number and age of children for whom each parent may be eligible to receive support

If you checked Box 1 above (shared), enter the number of children from 1a in the columns for both parents.

If you checked Box 2 above, enter the number of children from 1a in the column for Parent A, and enter 0 in the column for Parent B.

If you checked Box 3 above (split), enter the number of children primarily residing with each parent in each column.

d. Number of children under age 18

e. Number of children 18 years or older

f. Total number of children

+		+	
=		=	

2. INCOME AND COST INPUTS

a. Gross weekly income

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b. Social Security dependency benefits:

Do any of the children receive a dependency benefit from Social Security because of a parent's retirement or disability?

Yes

No

☐
☐

If yes, based on which parent's retirement or disability and past earnings?

Parent A

Parent B

☐
☐

Enter the amount of the dependency benefit Social Security actually sends to each parent.

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c. Add all amounts in 2b and enter the total in the column of the retired or disabled parent.

+		+	
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Parent A

Parent B

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Deductions:

- d. Other support obligations paid
- e. Health care premium/enrollment paid
- f. Dental/vision insurance cost paid

-	-

Credits:

- g. Child care cost paid for children covered by this order

Child:	1	2	3	4	5
Parent A					
Parent B					
Total					

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3. GROSS SUPPORT AMOUNTS

- a. Available income

$2a + 2c - 2d - 2e - 2f$,
but not less than \$0

=	=

- b. Combined available income

Parent A 3a + Parent B 3a

- c. Share of combined available income

$3a \div 3b$ (Min 0%, Max 100%)

- d. Applicable available income

3b or \$8,654, whichever is less

- e. Support amount for one child

From Table A or Guidelines Chart for 3d

- f. Adjustment for the number of children in 1f

From Table B

- g. Combined support amount

$3e \times 3f$

x	x
=	=

4. ADJUSTMENT FOR CHILDREN 18 YEARS OR OLDER

- a. Adjustment percentage for the ages
of the children listed in 1d and 1e

From Table C

x	x

- b. Adjustment for children 18 years or older

$3g \times 4a$

- c. Adjusted combined support amount

$3g - 4b$

=	=

5. PROPORTIONAL SUPPORT AMOUNTS

- a. Minus Each parent's share of support

$3c \times 4c$

- b. Other parent's share of support

$4c - 5a$

-	-
=	=

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Parent A

Parent B

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c. Other parent's share of support with low-income payor adjustment

If you checked Box 2 in 1b, enter \$0 for Parent B, and for Parent A:

If Parent B 3a > \$391, enter 5b.

If Parent B 3a ≤ \$391, enter the amount from the shaded area of the Guidelines Chart for Parent B 3a.

If you checked Box 1 or Box 3 in 1b, for each parent:

If the other parent's 3a > \$391, enter 5b.

If the other parent's 3a ≤ \$391, enter the amount from the shaded area of the Guidelines Chart for the other parent's 3a.

6. ADJUSTED SUPPORT AMOUNTS

Parent A

Parent B

a. Child care cost benchmark amount

For each child with an amount in 2g:

If the total child care cost paid by both parents (in the third row of 2g) ≤ \$430, use the actual amounts in 2g for each parent.

If the total child care cost paid by both parents > \$430, use for each parent: their share of 2g x (\$430 ÷ the total child care cost paid by both parents).

Add up the resulting amounts over all of the children and enter each parent's overall child care cost into the appropriate column in 6a.

b. Other parent's share of benchmark cost

For Parent A: Parent B 3c x Parent A 6a

For Parent B: Parent A 3c x Parent B 6a

c. Other parent's adjusted share of support

5c + 6b

d. Support as % of each parent's available income

If you checked Box 2 in 1b, enter "N/A".

If you checked Box 1 or Box 3 in 1b, enter 6c ÷ 3a (If 3a = 0, enter 100%).

e. Other parent's adjusted share of support

If 6d is ≥ 10% or is N/A, enter 6c for each parent.

If 6d is < 10%, enter 6c or ((6d + 10%) x the other parent's 3a), whichever is less, but not less than an amount from the shaded area of the Guidelines Chart.

f. Recipient and Payor

The Payor is responsible for paying child support for the children covered by this order to the Recipient.

If you checked Box 2 in 1b, enter "Recipient" for Parent A and "Payor" for Parent B.

Otherwise: Enter "Recipient" in the column with the higher amount in 6e and "Payor" in the other column.

If 6c is the same in both columns, enter "Recipient" in either column and "Payor" in the other column.

g. Payor's adjusted share of support

Enter Recipient 6e - Payor 6e, but not less than \$0, unless the below applies:

If you checked Box 1 or Box 3 in 1b, and there is a dependency benefit in Recipient 2c:

If you use the electronic worksheet on Mass.gov, it will automatically check this box for you and calculate the correct amount.

☐

If you are running the worksheet by hand, run a new worksheet replacing the Recipient's amount in 2c with the Recipient's amount from 2b. Keep all other figures the same, and check this box in the new worksheet.

Parent A	Parent B

7. PAYOR'S NET SUPPORT OBLIGATION

a. Support as % of Recipient's available income

If you checked Box 1 or Box 3 in 1b, enter "N/A".

If you checked Box 2 in 1b, enter 6g ÷ Recipient 3a (If Recipient 3a = 0, enter 100%).

b. Payor's support obligation adjusted for income disparity

If 7a is ≥ 10% or is N/A, enter 6g.

If 7a is < 10%, enter 6e, 6g, or ((7a + 10%) x Payor 3a), whichever is less, but not less than an amount from the shaded area of the Guidelines Chart.

c. Credit for Social Security dependency benefits paid

Enter from 2b the amount of the dependency benefit that Social Security sent directly to the Recipient due to the Payor's retirement or disability; if blank, enter \$0.

d. Payor's final support obligation

If 7b > 7c, enter 7b - 7c; otherwise enter \$0.

Payor pays Recipient

e. Support as % of Payor's available income

If Payor 3a = 0, enter 100%; otherwise 7d ÷ Payor 3a.

If 7e ≥ 40%, check the box at right; otherwise leave it blank.

The presumptive order is 40% or more of the payor's income; a rebuttable presumption of substantial hardship justifying a deviation exists.

8. ADDITIONAL INCOME ABOVE \$8,654

a. Combined additional income 3b - \$8,654 or \$0, whichever is more

b. Share of combined additional income 8a x 3c

TABLE A: CHILD SUPPORT OBLIGATION SCHEDULE								TABLE B:		TABLE C:						
All dollar amounts are weekly and rounded to the nearest dollar								ADJUSTMENT FOR		ADJUSTMENT FOR						
INCOME FROM WORKSHEET				CHILD SUPPORT AMOUNT (1 CHILD)				NUMBER OF CHILDREN		CHILDREN 18 YEARS OR OLDER						
		Minimum	Maximum					NUMBER OF CHILDREN	ADJUSTMENT FACTOR	CHILDREN UNDER 18	CHILDREN 18 OR OLDER					
											1	2	3	4	5	
COMBINED	PAYOR	\$ -	→	\$ 301	\$ 15	unless the court deviates			0	0.00	0	25%	25%	25%	25%	25%
		\$ 302	→	\$ 391	\$ 15 +	20%	above	\$ 301	1	1.00	1	7%	11%	13%	14%	
		\$ 392	→	\$ 1,000	22%				2	1.40	2	4%	6%	7%		
		\$ 1,001	→	\$ 1,600	\$ 220 +	21%	above	\$ 1,000	3	1.68	3	2%	3%			
		\$ 1,601	→	\$ 2,400	\$ 346 +	18%	above	\$ 1,600	4	1.85	4	1%				
		\$ 2,401	→	\$ 3,500	\$ 490 +	14%	above	\$ 2,400	5	1.94	5					
		\$ 3,501	→	\$ 5,000	\$ 644 +	11%	above	\$ 3,500								
		\$ 5,001	→	\$ 8,654	\$ 809 +	10%	above	\$ 5,000								